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NAVADMIN 046/26

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SUBJ/RETENTION EXCELLENCE AWARD//

REF/A/PUB/BUPERS/30SEP24//
REF/B/MSG/BUPERS/03SEP25//
REF/C/MSG/BUPERS/22SEP25//
REF/D/MSG/BUPERS/01DEC25//

NARR/REF A IS BUREAU OF NAVAL PERSONNEL CAREER COUNSELOR HANDBOOK.
REF B IS NAVADMIN 186/25, C-Note #1: SAILORS FIRST.
REF C IS NAVADMIN 203/25, C-Note #2: FOUNDRY ALWAYS.
REF D IS NAVADMIN 241/25, C-Note #3: WORLD-CLASS FLEET.

RMKS/1. This NAVADMIN announces the Fiscal Year (FY) 2026 retention environment, including reenlistment benchmarks, Retention Excellence Award (REA) criteria and Best in Class (BIC) requirements. It also reiterates the Navy's commitment to Sailors first and being built in the foundry which is the engine that drives our warfighting advantage in line with references (b) and (c).

2. FY26 Retention Environment. To ensure Fleet readiness in FY26 and beyond, we must strategically leverage all force management tools to attract, develop, and retain top Active Duty and Reserve talent. All Hands on Deck. Retaining experienced Sailors is our most powerful weapon, which secures victory. Leaders must ensure Sailors remain battle ready, trained, resilient, and forged in the foundry in line with reference (d), and inspire them to continue service in the Navy as a career.

3. FY26 Reenlistment Rate Benchmarks and Criteria. FY26 Legacy and BIC reenlistment benchmarks can be found on the MyNavy HR website at <https://www.mynavyhr.navy.mil/Career-Management/Career-Counseling/>.

a. Legacy Criteria. To qualify for the REA, commands must meet or exceed legacy benchmarks for at least 2 quarters or the FY overall and achieve a "Compliant" score on their annual Career Information Program Review (CIPR).

b. BIC Criteria. The BIC distinction recognizes commands optimizing principles in references (a) through (c). Commands meeting platform benchmarks, maintaining Zone A attrition below Navy benchmark, and achieving "Compliant" CIPR scores receive the REA and are considered for BIC. Echelon 3 commands will forward REA legacy and REA/BIC awardees to their respective echelon 2 command for official release of the recognition message.

c. Eligible commands must have a designated Command Career Counselor and at least 50 cumulative Sailors in zones A, B, and C, as identified by the non-average End of Active Obligated Service (EAOS) inventory on the Navy Retention Monitoring System "RET-ATT" report. Exceptions are determined by the applicable echelon 2 Commander.

d. Computation Exceptions. If a zone has no Sailors reaching EAOS, but the command has qualifying transactions in Zones A through C, that zone's reenlistment rate will default to the minimum required benchmark. Commands must have qualifying transactions in at least one zone.

e. To request an Exception to Policy (ETP) for any award element in paragraph 3, submit a written request with justification through your Immediate Superior In Command (ISIC)/Type Commander (TYCOM), signed by the Commanding Officer. Disapproved ETPs will not be considered. Echelon 2 commands have final ETP approval authority. TYCOMs and direct reporting counselors will submit eligible commands to echelon 2 by 1 December 2026.

4. Legacy REA and BIC Announcement Recognition

a. Echelon 2 commands should announce their FY26 REA legacy and BIC recipients by 31 January 2027, after consolidating submissions from echelon 3 and direct reporting commands.

b. Following the announcement, REA/BIC awardees may fly the BIC pennant (blue, silver anchor) and paint their anchor gold. Legacy REA award winners and BIC contenders meeting benchmarks, but not selected for BIC, may fly the Retention Award pennant (gold, blue anchor).

5. Points of Contact

a. Deputy Chief of Naval Operations for Personnel, Manpower, and Training, N1, Fleet Career Counselor, NCCM(SW/AW/IW) James Osborne, at (703) 604-5353/DSN 664 or via e-mail at james.r.osborne.mil@us.navy.mil.

b. U.S. Fleet Forces, Fleet Career Counselor, NCCM(SW/AW/IW) Justin McNicol, at (757) 836-7780/DSN 836 or via e-mail at justin.r.mcnicol.mil@us.navy.mil.

c. U.S. Pacific Fleet, Fleet Career Counselor, NCCM(SW/SW) Jason Caldera, at (808) 474-5848/DSN 315 or via e-mail at jason.caldera.mil@us.navy.mil.

d. Naval Forces Europe and Africa, Fleet Career Counselor, NCCM(SW/AW) Lalia M. Canlas, at +39-081-568-3497/DSN 314-626-3497 or via e-mail at lalia.m.canlas.mil@us.navy.mil

e. Enlisted Force Plans and Policy Branch (OPNAV N132), Mr. John Motichka, at (703) 604-5394/DSN 664 or via e-mail at john.a.motichka.civ@us.navy.mil.

6. Released by Vice Admiral Jeffrey J. Czerewko, N1.//

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